Monthly Briefs ××× Master Template

[CLIENT] — [Month Year] Briefs

> **How to use this template.** Five briefs, one month, one client. They are written in Week 3 of the cycle (Preproduction) and approved by the Creative Director before the end of that week. Everything in them traces to the client's Content Strategy (portal → Content Overview → Content Strategy). **A brief never introduces anything the strategy doesn't already contain**; new ideas go into the strategy's idea bank first.
>
> **Where each one lives in Notion**
>
> - Content Brief + Media Day + Scripts → *Project Boards → Video Production Management → Video Post Production Board*. Set **Client** (relation), **Film Date**, **Delivery Date**, **Videographer**, **Editor**, **Project Type**, **Aspect Ratio**, **Deliverables**, **Deliverables Tracker**. The Client relation is what routes it to the client's portal.
> - Graphics Brief → *Project Boards → Graphic Management → Graphic Design Board*. Set **Client**, **Month**, **Deliverables**, **Designer**, **Date Range**, **Aspect Ratios / Sizing**, **Deliverables Tracker**.
> - Ads Brief → the ads board, same Client relation.
>
> **The tag on every line item:** Pillar · Bucket · Job · Series (media: format). If a line can't be tagged with all four, it isn't ready.
>
> Replace every `[bracket]`. Delete the italic instructions before sharing with the client.

Brief 1: Content Brief

Client: [name] · **Month:** [month year] · **Prepared by:** [name] · **Approved by (Creative Director):** [name, date]

This month

Goal: [one line, from the strategy. What this month has to move.]

Theme (if any): [name]. [One or two sentences. A theme is time-bound; it has an end date. If there isn't one, say "none; standard pillar work."]

What's in these briefs: Content Brief (this), Media Day + Shot List, Video Scripts, Graphics Brief, Ads Brief.

Pillar mix and deliverable count

Package: [name] ([videos] videos, [graphics] graphics, [posts] posts). *Counts come from Contracted Monthly Deliverables; never deliver under contract.*

Pillar	Strategy baseline	This month	Why it moved	Videos	Graphics	Posts
[Pillar 1]	[%]	[%]	[on plan / reason]			
[Pillar 2]	[%]	[%]				
[Pillar 3]	[%]	[%]				
Total				**[n]**	**[n]**	**[n]**

Bucket check: [every bucket appears at least once; none over half the month. Note any gap and why.]

Not counted against contract: [one-time or foundation assets this month, if any]

Video list ([n])

#	Piece	Pillar	Bucket	Job	Series (format)	Length	Talent	Recurring message
V1								
V2								

Script and per-video shot list for every piece: see Brief 3.

Photo list

Photos as content (posted on their own)

#	Set	Pillar	Bucket	Job	Format	Notes
P1						

Photos for graphics (the list the graphics team needs this month)

#	Set	Needed by (graphic #)	Notes
P2			

After the shoot, photos are filed by pillar and photo format (Hero, Portrait, Environment, Detail, Lifestyle, Event, Product) in the client's Drive folder.

Graphic list ([n])

#	Piece	Pillar	Bucket	Job	Series (format)	Photo needed	Recurring message
G1							

Theme / seasonal set this month: [the set, or "none"]

Series, one-offs and messages

Series continuing: [list, with episode number] **Series starting this month:** [list] **One-offs built this month and reused:** [list] **One-offs being resurfaced:** [list]

Recurring messages in play

Message	Carried by
"[message]"	V#, G#

Photo needs for next month's graphics

[The graphics team writes this; production shoots it as its own segment. Three to six items: "two product close-ups in one light," "one environment from the street," "seasonal set for [theme]."]

Approval checklist (copied from the strategy, section 9)

- ☐ [guardrail]
- ☐ [guardrail]
- ☐ Captions: no em-dashes or en-dashes
- ☐ Client approver signed off: [name]

Posting plan

Week	Pillar focus	Posts	What goes out
[dates]			

Posting follows the client's cadence in SMM Posting Calendar Patterns and the Content Monthly Deliverables page: 8 AM–8 PM client local, times varied, no [days] if contracted.

Timeline against the cycle

Cycle week	Dates	What happens
Week 3: Preproduction	[dates]	Briefs written, scripts and shot lists done, Creative Director approves, client approves, talent and shoot confirmed
Week 4: Production	[dates]	Shoot days; raw footage uploaded; editing briefs assigned; graphics start from the photo set
Week 1: Production + Post	[dates]	Edits and graphics finished; internal review; client review; all production complete by end of week
Week 2: Post + Scheduling	[dates]	Approved content scheduled; calendar sent to client; ads live; brainstorm for next cycle

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Brief 2: Media Day Brief and Shot List

Project: [client, month] · **Shoot:** [date(s), locations, hours] · **Team lead:** [name] · **Client lead on the day:** [name]

1. Objective

[Two or three sentences: what this shoot captures and what it feeds. Name the counts.]

Final deliverables: [n videos (length range), photo sets as content, photo sets for graphics, B-roll library]

2. Content breakdown, by segment

*Vocabulary: pillar = what we talk about; bucket = Awareness, Desire, Story, Choice; job = the piece's intent. A shoot-day grouping is a **segment**, never a "bucket." One segment per pillar so the crew shoots one world at a time.*

Segment 1: [Pillar] ([time of day, who needs to be there])

Series	Bucket	Job	Media: format	Pieces	Est. time
				V#, P#	

Segment 2: [Pillar]

Series	Bucket	Job	Media: format	Pieces	Est. time

Segment 3: [Pillar]

Series	Bucket	Job	Media: format	Pieces	Est. time

Photo segment (for graphics)

Set	Needed by	Est. time

3. Shot list

Talking heads (one idea per video; two takes each, tight and medium; each ends with its recurring message to camera)

- [ ] V# [title]

Skits

- [ ] V# [title]: [beats; alt punchlines to capture]

Testimonial / behind the scenes

- [ ] V# [title]: [prompts]

B-roll library (gimbal; wide, medium, close on everything)

- [ ] [location / action]

Photos (full spec in the Content Brief photo list)

- [ ] P# [set]

4. Talent

Who	Pieces	Wardrobe	Release
			[ ]

5. Locations and logistics

- [Location 1: address, parking, access, contact]
- [Location 2]
- [Rooms needed: quiet room for talking heads, etc.]

6. Gear

- Cameras: [primary, second body]
- Audio: [lavs, shotgun]
- Light: [key/fill, bounce]
- [Gimbal, tripod, backdrop]

7. Style and tone

- Visual: [from the strategy's bucket qualities and mood board]
- Talking heads: [framing, eye line, one idea per video, no teleprompter]
- Skits: [pacing, who plays whom, what's off-limits]
- Portraits: [same light, same background, same framing]

8. Schedule

Time	Segment
[call time]	Crew call, set stations
	Segment 1
	Segment 2
	Lunch; B-roll over lunch

Time	Segment
	Segment 3
	Pickups, photo sets, wrap

9. Post-production

- Edit priority: [which pieces first, in posting order]
- Series name tells the editor the cut; job tells the tone: [notes]
- Raw footage and photo sets to [Drive folder], filed by pillar and format

10. Approvals before the shoot

- [ ] Strategy and briefs approved by client
- [ ] Recurring messages finalized (they're said on camera)
- [ ] Creative Director approved the brief
- [ ] Talent confirmed and releases ready
- [ ] Locations confirmed
- [ ] Compliance / approver contact named for same-day questions

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Brief 3: Video Scripts and Shot Lists

*One block per video. **Script** is talking points and suggested lines, not a word-for-word read; talent says it in their own words, one idea per video, and ends on the recurring message to camera. **Shots** is what to capture for that piece beyond the main setup. Scripts follow the strategy's guardrails; if a line needs something banned to work, cut the line.*

Legend: TH = talking head · INS = insert / B-roll · CARD = on-screen text or graphic in the edit

[Pillar 1]

V1 · [Title]

[Pillar] · [Bucket] · [Job] · [Series] ([format]) · [length] · [talent]

Script

- Hook: "[first line, under 3 seconds]"
- Beat 1: [point]
- Beat 2: [point]
- Beat 3: [point]
- Close: "[recurring message, said to camera]"

Shots

- [ ] TH, tight and medium
- [ ] INS: [what]
- [ ] CARD: [end card text], [disclosure bar if required]

V2 · [Title]

[tag line]

Script (beats, improvise the lines) *for skits*

- [beat]
- Alt punchlines (shoot all): (1) [ ] (2) [ ] (3) [ ]

Shots

- [ ]

V3 · [Title]

[tag line]

Script (interview prompts, their words) *for testimonials and behind the scenes*

- "[open question]"
- "[open question]"
- Close: let them say it; CARD if needed

Shots

- [ ]

[Pillar 2]

V# · [Title]

[Pillar 3]

V# · [Title]

Brief 4: Graphics Brief

Project: [client, month] · **Deliverables:** [n] counted graphics [+ foundation set if any] · **Due:** drafts [date], finals [date] · **Assigned:** [designer]

1. Objective

[Two sentences. What this month's graphics do in the funnel and which photo set they depend on. Design starts the day after the shoot, not before.]

2. Brand context

- Tone: [from the strategy, section 4]
- Positioning: [one line]
- Language: [approved / banned terms]
- Guardrails: [the two or three that affect graphics most; full checklist in the Content Brief]

3. Visual direction

- Photo-first or type-first: [which, and why]
- Palette and type: [brand guidelines link, or "propose two directions from the mood board before building"]
- Templates: [one carousel, one single-image, one functional; build these first]
- Mood board: [link], sections used this month: [list]
- Don't: [stock photos, clip-art, urgency devices, anything that looks like a competitor's ad]

4. Content breakdown

Carousels

#	Piece	Tag (Pillar · Bucket · Job · Series)	Slides	Photo	Copy direction
G1					

Single-image and functional

#	Piece	Tag	Photo	Copy direction
G#				

Seasonal / theme set (if any)

#	Piece	Tag	Dates	Photo	Copy direction

Foundation set (one-time, if any this month)

Piece	Spec	Notes
Profile image		
Cover / banner		[required disclosure visible]
Recurring-message cards	1080×1080 and 1080×1920	one per message
Story highlight covers		

5. Key messaging

Primary: [one line]. Secondary: [one or two]. Recurring messages are in the Content Brief; use them as closers exactly as the client finalized them.

6. Technical specs

- Feed: 1080×1350 (4:5) carousels and single images; 1080×1080 for cards
- Story: 1080×1920 with safe zones
- Export: PNG for feed, PDF for carousels to client review, source files to client Drive
- [Required disclosure] in the same position on every piece, set once in the template
- Captions supplied with each piece: no em-dashes or en-dashes

7. Revision rounds and approval

- Round 1: internal review against the bucket qualities ([Choice: Simple, Direct...] [Desire: Clear, Reassuring...])
- Round 2: client review; [compliance-sensitive pieces] go to the client's approver first
- Final: approval checklist in the Content Brief signed per piece

8. Special instructions

- [The most sensitive piece this month and why it gets reviewed first]
- [Anything partner / co-brand related]
- If brand guidelines don't exist yet, the templates built this month become them; document choices as you go

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Brief 5: Ad Campaign Brief

Project: [client, month] · **Flight:** [dates] · **Media buyer:** [name] · **Budget:** [amount, split below as percentages]

1. Campaign goals

Goal	Measured by

Ads amplify the organic content; they don't replace it. Every ad creative is a cut of a piece from the Content Brief, tagged the same way.

2. Audiences and platform constraints

Instruction: name any platform rules that apply to this category (e.g., Meta Special Ad Categories for housing, credit, employment: no age/gender/ZIP targeting, 15-mile minimum radius, no lookalikes). The creative does the targeting the platform won't.

Audience	Platform	How it's built
[cold]		
[warm]		
[hot]		
[test]		

Every ad: [required disclosures in frame or primary text]; [banned claims]; no pressure language.

3. Funnel and creative

Stage	Bucket	Creative (Pillar · Job · Series)	Cut	Audience	Spend share
Top	Awareness			cold	[%]
Mid	Desire			warm	[%]
Mid	Story			warm	[%]
Bottom	Choice			hot	[%]
Test					[%]

Landing pages

- [Page 1: what it says, what the form asks, what it doesn't do]
- [Page 2]

4. Platform notes

- Meta: [placements, category declaration, frequency cap, primary text]
- YouTube: [format, radius, companion]
- LinkedIn: [format, audiences]
- [Test campaign]: separate campaign and budget so results read on their own

5. Measurement and the weekly read

Week	Read
1	delivery and frequency; cheapest 3s views by creative
2	warm audience size; watch time; first conversions
3	cost per [conversion] on the hot layer; shift spend
4	test read; recommendation for next month

Report by bucket in the monthly review, so the client sees whether awareness turned into [conversations / bookings / sales].

6. Approvals before launch

- [ ] Client approver signed off on every ad creative and landing page
- [ ] Platform category and disclosure requirements confirmed
- [ ] Landing pages live with required disclosures and a working form routed to a named person
- [ ] Pixel and conversion events firing
- [ ] Budget split approved

Vocabulary (fixed; do not rename)

Pillar (what we talk about) · Bucket (Awareness · Desire · Story · Choice; never renamed) · Job (Educate · Entertain · Inspire · Empathize · Prove · Convert) · Series (named, repeatable, one pillar × bucket cell) · Media (Video · Photo · Graphic) · Format (the production shape) · Theme (time-bound) · Segment (a shoot-day grouping, production briefs only).

Source: Launchpad Content Framework Method (brain: Skills/Content Framework Method). Example of a finished set: First Colony Mortgage, November 2026 Briefs.